

Leave at all costs

A short text adventure about escaping a very boring class

Player guide

The story

You are in high school, sitting through the most boring Civics class of your life, and you cannot take it any longer. After a few choices that may or may not end well for you, you find yourself out in the school corridors. Unfortunately, the exit is locked. Use the items you find and the people you meet to get out of school, **AT ALL COSTS**.

Goal

There are **10 endings**, good and bad. Your goal is to reach all of them. A good ending means you leave the school without any hiccups; everything else is a bad one. Each attempt must be finished within **40 turns** — run out of time and the principal catches you (this does not count as an ending). Endings are remembered between attempts: after an ending, choose *Program* → *Try again* to play again.

The game rewards paying attention to details: read the location descriptions carefully.

Running the game

- You need Java 8 or newer. Double-click `At all costs (executable).jar`, or run `java -jar "At all costs (executable).jar"` in a terminal.
- *Program* → *Map* opens the school map (`map.png`) in your image viewer. Keep `map.png` in the same folder as the `.jar` file. The map is also on page 3 of this guide.

How to play

The game has two phases.

1. **Multiple choice.** First type your name. After that, every turn gives you two options: answer 1 or 2.
2. **Adventure.** You walk around the school by typing commands:

Command	What it does
<i>go direction</i>	Move north, south, east, west, northeast, . . . , up or down.
<i>get item</i>	Pick up an item you see.
<i>drop item</i>	Put down an item you are carrying.
<i>examine item</i>	Take a closer look at an item you are carrying.
<i>use item</i>	Use an item you are carrying.
<i>inventory</i>	List what you are carrying.
<i>ask</i>	Ask the person here for a favour.
<i>rest</i>	Wait for a turn.
<i>help</i>	Show the instructions.
<i>endings</i>	List the endings you have reached.
<i>quit</i>	Give up this attempt.

Some things to know:

- **There are more commands than the ones listed.** They are single verbs hinted at in the location descriptions (sometimes you have to infer them!).
- Commands are not case-sensitive, and extra spaces are ignored.
- *help*, *endings* and commands the game does not understand do not use up a turn. Everything else does.

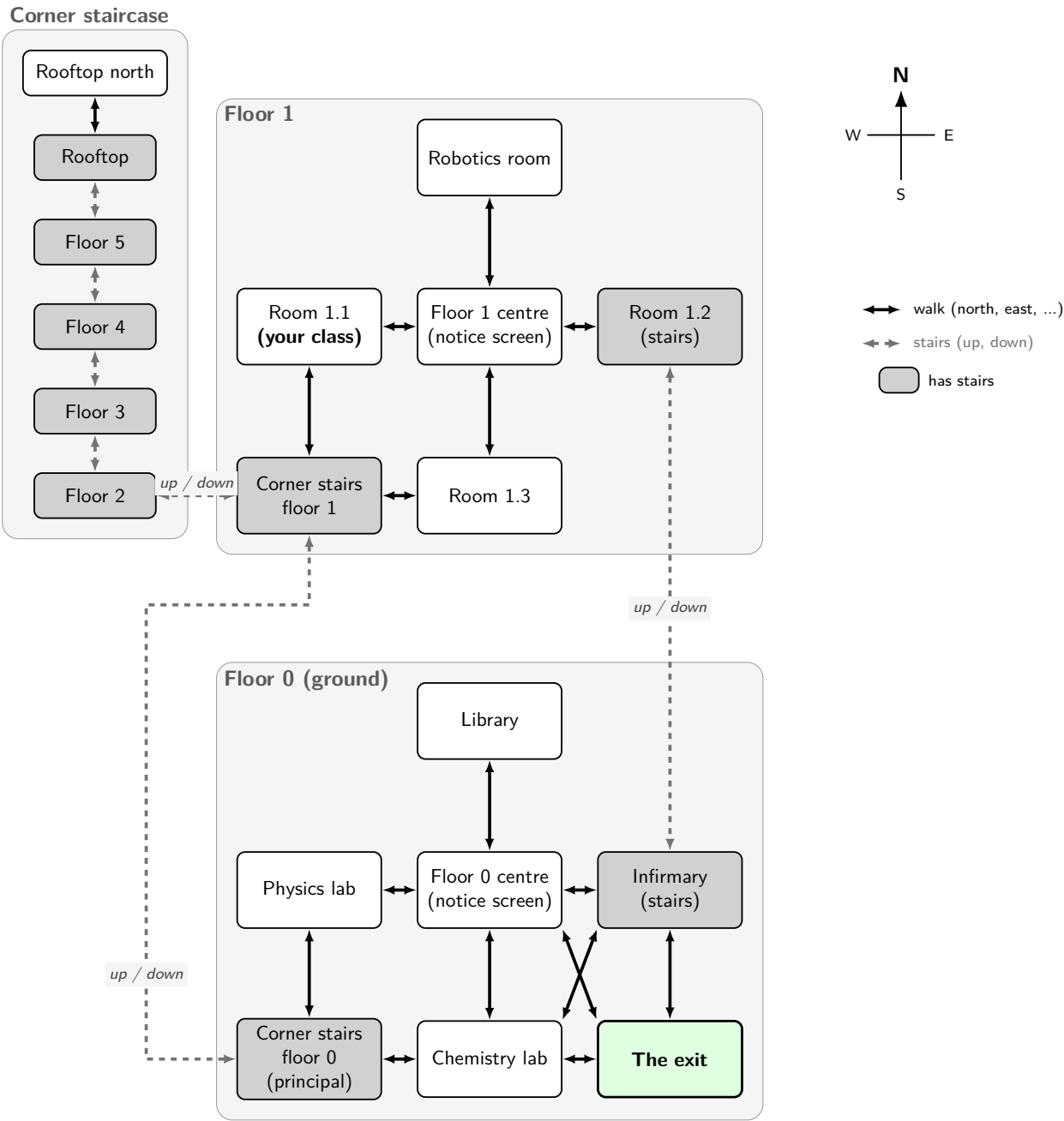
Endings

	Ending	Kind
1	Zzz. . . Zzz	bad
2	Humiliating!	bad
3	Stick to your lies!	bad
4	Thank god for the nurse.	good
5	Lucky it ran on battery!	good
6	Dexterity 100!	good
7	Certified pyromaniac	good?
8	A-Are you okay?	bad
9	You already lied once. . .	bad
10	Fool around and find out!	bad

The school map is on the next page, the walkthrough on the last page. Have a go before reading the walkthrough!

School map

North is up and east is to the right, matching the directions used in the game. Grey rooms have stairs, so you can go up and/or down from there.



Walkthrough (spoilers!)

Multiple-choice phase

- After you give your name, choosing to ignore the urge to sneak out makes you fall asleep in class → **bad** ending *Zzz... Zzz.*
- Otherwise you can **fake being ill** or **ask to go to the toilet**.
- Going to the toilet starts the adventure right outside your class (Room 1.1).
- If you fake being ill, you must let the teacher take you to the infirmary; refusing gives you away → **bad** ending *Humiliating!*
- The nurse asks what is wrong. You had been coughing and sniffing, so claiming a headache does not add up → **bad** ending *Stick to your lies!*
- Complaining about your breathing and throat works: the nurse gives you a sick note and the adventure starts at the infirmary.

Adventure phase: four ways to unlock the exit

1. **Sick note.** Get a sick note from the nurse (**ask** at the infirmary, unless you already have one) and **ask** the principal at the floor-0 corner stairs to unlock the exit → **good** ending *Thank god for the nurse.*
2. **Prying.** Get the *motor* from the robotics room and **ask** the physics lab instructor for a *wrench*. At the exit, **use motor**, **use wrench** or **pry** → **good** ending *Lucky it ran on battery!*
3. **Acid.** Get the *black bottle* (sulphuric acid) from the chemistry lab and **use black bottle** at the exit → **good** ending *Dexterity 100!*
4. **Fire.** Get the *red canister* (fuel) from the floor-2 stairs and the black bottle, then go to the library and **use red canister**, **use black bottle** or **burn**. The fire alarm unlocks the exit → **good?** ending *Certified pyromaniac.*

Only the first way you unlock the exit counts: once it is open, the other methods (and the principal) will not work any more.

Accidents

- If you faked being ill, your teacher is watching the corridor. Spend 3 turns outside your class (Room 1.1) and they notice → **bad** ending *You already lied once...* (This cannot happen if you went “to the toilet”.)
- After starting the fire, spend 2 more turns in the library, in one go or over several visits, and you pass out in the smoke. You are rescued, but arrested for arson → **bad** ending *Fool around and find out!*
- Climb the corner staircase all the way to the rooftop. The railing to the north is broken; from there **jump** or **go down** → **bad** ending *A-Are you okay?* This is meant to be the hardest ending to find: only a small hint in the text says you can jump.

Running out of turns (40) ends the attempt without unlocking an ending.

If you or someone you know is in a crisis, help is available. Contact your local emergency number or a crisis helpline.